

Prerequisites

I tried to keep these minimal without compromising a natural development of the subject. This book only requires familiarity with

From algebra. Basic properties of groups, rings (always associative with 1), fields, polynomials, linear maps and their matrices and determinants.

From topology. The notions of (Hausdorff) topological space, closure and interior, continuity of functions between topological spaces, connectedness.

From analysis. Elementary calculus of real-valued functions of real arguments. In Chapter 2 we use at one point the argument principle from complex analysis.

The logical dependence of chapters on earlier ones is roughly as follows:

